



Inspiring Excellence

**POL 102: Comparative Governance (Section 1)
Final Exam (Final Research Paper), Spring 2026
Full Points: 100 points (40% of your final grade)**

Online Submission deadline: 11.59 PM, May 13th, 2026 (via Turnitin)

Read the instructions (on the first and last pages) and the questions carefully before writing the lit review. Plagiarism will not be accepted. In-text citations and a reference page are required.

STEPS TO CONSTRUCTING THE FINAL RESEARCH PAPER:

1. Construct a 2000- 2500-word final research paper that is driven by your research puzzle.
2. Sections:

A dedicated Cover Page

- a. **Introduction:** (Two paragraphs) Briefly introduce your topic (theme/SDG selected from the topic selection assignment) and why this is important (Cite Sources). The countries you have selected and the theoretical approach (cite sources) you will be utilizing for this paper assignment. The second paragraph focuses on your puzzle and frames it as a question (please try to use why/how/to what extent). Then you discuss the three indicators and the timeline.
- b. **Literature Review:** (Between **6 to 10 paragraphs**) This section starts with the importance of comparative governance study (use syllabus sources to cite here). Then discuss how the global system shapes state development and state capacity. Distinguish between strong vs weak states and share what your two selected countries are based on the syllabus readings (you may also include Fragile State Index score to support your claim). After that discuss the preferred theoretical Approach for your research paper. Now, the final two to three paragraphs discuss the themes or SDGs, bringing in external peer-reviewed sources. (Please read and follow the Turnitin Feedback to update this section.)
- c. **Empirical Evidence and Longitudinal Trajectories: (3 to 6 Paragraphs)** I would recommend start by sharing that prior empirical studies utilizes World Bank Data to track SDG and thematic shifts and changes over time. Then start by introducing your data source and describing the steps you took to prepare the data for a balanced comparison. Please use subheadings for each indicator to show how they represent your selected SDG or theme. It is helpful to define the mechanism and scale of each indicator so the reader understands if a higher or lower score represents institutional strength. I recommend you maintain a descriptive tone rather than a causal one, focusing on how these indicators shifted over time. Please identify and explain at least two significant inflection points for each country by providing the real-world context, such as a reform or a crisis, behind those changes.
- d. **Limitations:** You can conclude this section by identifying the specific constraints of your study, such as the reliance on aggregate national data or gaps in the reporting timeline.

- e. **Future Works** I encourage you to suggest how future research could address these limitations, perhaps by incorporating qualitative interviews or additional resources to deepen the comparative analysis.
- f. **Conclusion** Please provide a final summary of your most critical findings and their broader implications for your theme.
- g. **References** List all scholarly sources and datasets in a full reference list formatted according to APA guidelines.

Points break down- 100 points.

Introduction and literature review(Revised and Updated from Midterm Feedback)-20 points

Empirical Evidence and Longitudinal Trajectories – 25 points

Appropriate Analysis, Figures, Labels, Citations- 20 points

Contributions and Limitations - 15 points

Citations and Bibliography- 10 points

Writing style and structure- 10 points

General Instructions

- a) Font - Times New Roman, 12-point size. Spacing - 1.5. Citation style – APA 7th Edition (must be consistent throughout the paper). All sources, including primary sources (assigned readings), must **be cited**. In-text citations are required (word counts do not include in-text citations). Sources must be academic. Please include a **bibliography** or reference page.
- b) Students are strongly discouraged from using AI-generated materials. If Turnitin indicates substantial AI-generated content or exceeds the course threshold for the Turnitin AI score (**50%**), it may result in penalties, including zero.
- c) Similarity scores above 15% may lead to closer review and mark reduction if they reflect improper borrowing of academic materials. Scores **above 20%** will usually not be accepted unless the match is clearly due to reference list, technical glitches, or assignment formatting. Turnitin allows multiple submissions until the deadline, so take advantage of this.
- d) The assignment must be submitted **as a Word document**. The assignment must be submitted by the specified deadline.
- e) Late submissions will be penalized with a **5%-point deduction** per day, and the assignment will not be accepted if more than 2 days late. The final exam paper is due on May 13th and will not be accepted after May 15th 2026. Thank you so much for your consideration and engagement.